



open data
services

Governance

**Risk Data Library Standard
v1.0 and beyond**



Version 1.0 release

Version 1.0 release

Typical approach:

- Public call for feedback on draft release via GitHub Discussions
- Provide a high level summary of changes + link to changelog
- Invite governance group, WB teams and other specialists to review
- Respond to feedback
- Governance group approves final release
- Release

OFDS 0.4: Draft release ready for review #336

duncandewhurst announced in [Announcements](#)



duncandewhurst on Feb 19 Maintainer

edited ...

The [draft of OFDS version 0.4](#) is ready for review. The deadline for feedback on the draft release is **Wednesday 11th March 2026**.

You can provide feedback in this discussion thread, or by commenting on an issue in the issue on the [project board](#). Please indicate whether your feedback is a blocker that must be addressed before release.

Changes

The key changes in the draft release are listed below with links to relevant sections of the documentation. For more information on the context and background for each change, see the related issues linked in the pull request.

Ref	Change	Documentation	Pull request	Notes
1	Specify the logical data model separately from the schemas for supported data formats	Data model reference Data formats reference	#310	Includes minor changes to property titles and descriptions to support reuse across the logical data model and supported data formats.
2	Add GeoPackage as a supported data format	GeoPackage reference	#310	

[Example \(Open Fibre Data Standard\)](#)



**Post version 1.0:
Good practice from other
standards**



Who makes decisions, and how?

Governance group

- Responsible for the strategic direction and technical development of the Standard.
- Oversee appropriate and timely development, maintenance and promotion of the Standard and its Tooling.
- Approves Major and Minor version changes and oversees community consultation process.
- Thought needed on group composition and route to membership.



Terms of Reference and a Secretariat role

- **Terms of Reference (ToR)** - document the group's scope, decision-making rules, conflict of interest policy and review cycle. Publish it publicly.
- **Secretariat** - GFDRR or a delegated team to manage operational matters: meeting logistics, issue triage, community communications. OFDS uses Internet Society; IATI has a dedicated secretariat team.
- **Chair** - appointed by the group, liaises with the secretariat, convenes meetings and ensures members receive documentation in advance.
- **Decision-making** - prioritise consensus, fall back to simple majority vote. Consider the IETF "Rough Consensus" model (RFC 7282).

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Decision-making

Prioritise consensus, fall back to simple majority vote. Consider the IETF 'Rough Consensus' model (RFC 7282).



How do changes get proposed, reviewed and released?

- Adhere to the five fundamental principles of standards development defined by the OpenStand movement: Due process, Broad consensus, Transparency, Balance, and Openness.
- Issues, bugs, and new feature ideas can be proposed by anyone at any point via the GitHub issue tracker.
- Semantic Versioning (MAJOR.MINOR) to distinguish between types of changes:
- Major Versions: Backwards-incompatible changes (e.g., 2.0).
- Minor Versions: Functionality additions in a backwards-compatible manner (e.g., 1.4).
- Major and Minor Changes are approved by the Governance Group.
- Iterative Improvements are shared with peer reviewers for acceptance.

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OpenStand Principles

Adhere to the five fundamental principles of standards development:
Due process, Broad consensus,
Transparency, Balance, and Openness.

Change Process & Versioning



Proposals

Issues, bugs, and new feature ideas can be proposed by anyone via GitHub.



Semantic Versioning

MAJOR.MINOR distinguishes changes:
Major Versions (e.g., 2.0): Backwards-incompatible.
Minor Versions (e.g., 1.4): Functionality additions, backwards-compatible.

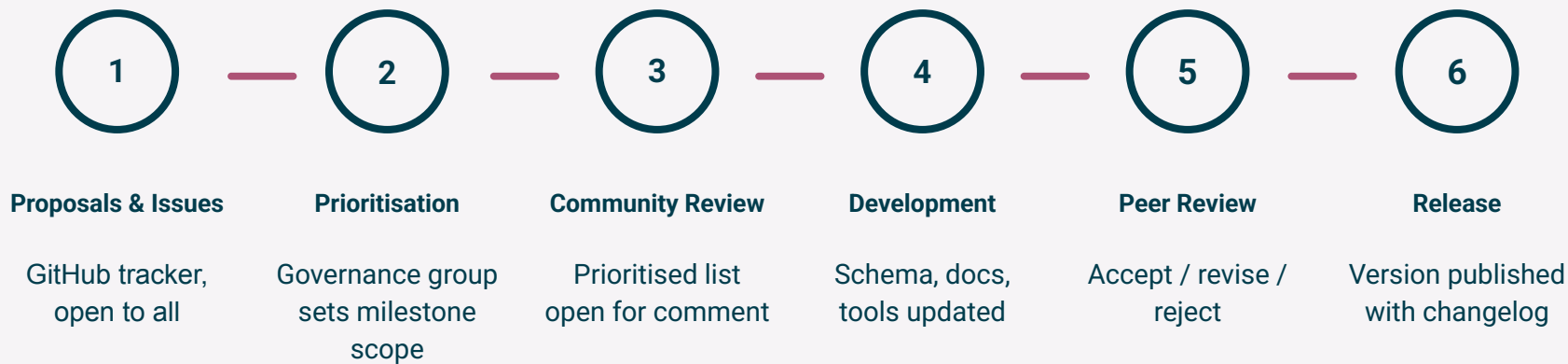


Approval

Major and Minor Changes approved by Governance Group.
Iterative Improvements shared with peer reviewers.



Example change process



This mirrors the OFDS workflow and OCDS revision process. Anyone can submit an issue, only the governance group approves Major/Minor versions. Small iterative improvements go to peer review only.



Versioning, changelogs and deprecation

Adopt Semantic Versioning - Stated in docs, but only applies from 1.0 onwards

Changelog - Done for versions 0.2 and 0.3, needs to be kept up to date

Normative vs non-normative - Content separated, but needs to be documented

Deprecation policy - TBD

Support policy (supporting previous versions) - TBD



Build and sustain your community

- **GitHub Issues - technical change proposals**
- **GitHub Discussions - broader community conversation**
- **Mailing list or forum - non-technical stakeholders**
- **Public meeting notes from governance group**

Transparency: publish all governance decisions, ToR, membership lists and meeting summaries on the RDLS website or GitHub.



Recommended actions for RDLS

Before working on the next release (v1.1 or v2.0)...

- Develop a change process
- Agree on deprecation, support, and normative content policies
- Document the above in the RDLS documentation